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WHAT'S COROMANDEL INTERNATIONAL

- **Largest Indian NPK player in the private sector**
- **Largest speciality and organic marketer**
- **Largest single super phosphate player**
- **The third-largest crop protection player in India**
- **Largest rural retail store network (1,000+)**
- **Largest neem bioproducts manufacturing**

Source Coromandel investor presentation, December 2025

The past three years, in particular, have been critical for Coromandel. "What we did right was strengthening the company's fundamentals rather than chasing only front-end expansion," he says. In this commodity-influenced business, there was disproportionate focus on two levers: operational innovation and supply chain resilience.

When Alagappan took charge, Coromandel was importing 65% of its sulphuric acid requirement. He, along with his team, decided to explore how the company could add more value and bolster margins by reducing imports.

The company looked at each process and zeroed in on mining. It could either own a mine or enter into long-term contracts with those who did, says Alagappan. Towards the end of 2022, Coromandel picked up a 45% stake in Baobab Mining and Chemicals Corporation, a Senegal-based rock phosphate mining company and last July upped that to 71.5%. This has given the company "mining-linked capability."

Another key decision related to securing critical raw material. "It moved from just being an advantage to a hygiene factor. We invested time and leadership bandwidth to derisk sourcing, deepen vendor partnerships and build flexibility across our inbound supply chain to make sure we could serve the farm sector without disruption," says Alagappan.

Coromandel also increased captive capacity for key inputs. "We reduced import dependence for key raw materials from around 65% to 40%. This has improved resilience, reduced volatility and given us better continuity of supply," says Alagappan.

The company also decided to make manufacturing excellence a priority. It drove disciplined process innovation and removed bottlenecks across plants. "That led to meaningful output improvement with minimal incremental capex. For instance, we have been able to lift production volumes by around 20% in some facilities primarily through process and operating discipline," Alagappan says.

Apart from de-risking its supply chain, Coromandel increased the breadth of offerings and strengthened the integrated agri-solutions platform. "We are strong in manufacturing and market access. That includes making nutrients at a large scale, leadership in complex fertilisers and having a pan-India distribution engine, with a deep last-mile presence through our rural retail network," says Alagappan.

The other factor that differentiates Coromandel is a portfolio-led model. This allows it to have a play across nutrients, crop protection, bio-products and tech-led solutions. "It lets us solve a broader crop outcome prob-